

Responsible AI Use Policy

Dean's Update

Patrick Hall

jphall@gwu.edu

September 16, 2026

Disclosure: AI tools such as Gemini and NotebookLM were used throughout the policy drafting and review process and to draft this presentation.

Purpose

Purpose of these slides: Brief the Dean on the Responsible AI Use Policy process to date.

Purpose of the policy: The policy is a standard governance tool, intended to establish practical rules for AI use within GWSB, enabling the GWSB community to focus on their work rather than the complexities of AI governance.

Overall goal: Release Responsible AI Use Policy before the Fall 2026 semester.

Purpose (Cont.)

The policy is designed to:

- Provide a high-level institutional framework for responsible AI use.
- Help faculty, staff, researchers, and students understand what is appropriate, inappropriate, or requires additional review.
- Fill gaps between existing institutional policies where AI creates new ambiguity.
- Give community members clarity when they encounter unethical uses, sensitive data issues, or other edge cases.
- Support responsible AI adoption while protecting academic integrity, privacy, intellectual property, and institutional trust.

Scope note: The policy is not intended to serve as a complete AI governance framework or detailed technical standard for AI system development.

Process: Initial Draft

Initial policy draft: “Responsible AI Use Policy (Draft) v1.1” (Request access via Google Drive)

Release date: April 23, 2026; Email subject: “Request for Feedback: Draft GWSB Responsible AI Use Policies”

Drafting basis:

- Review of GW’s existing policies and guidance.
- A broad survey of university AI policies.
- Attention to recurring institutional issues involving:
 - Academic integrity.
 - Data privacy.
 - Public AI tools.
 - AI use in teaching, research, and administrative work.
 - Student-facing syllabus guidance.

Process: Public Comment

Feedback received: Feedback was collected through **June 1, 2026**. Faculty and staff submitted 40 points of feedback.

Comment records: [Written feedback](#) and [Parsed feedback](#) (Request access via Google Drive)

General pattern:

- Nonactionable feedback expressed general support for the draft or provided informational references.
- Actionable feedback included specific requests for clarification, revision, or implementation support.

Public Comment: Feedback Themes

Actionable feedback focused on several recurring issues:

- Clarifying default rules for student AI use.
- Clarifying when AI use must be disclosed.
- Clarifying faculty and GA/TA use of AI, especially in grading.
- Distinguishing “should” from “must” language.
- Adding a mechanism for policy updates and future review.
- Improving reimbursement and purchasing guidance.
- Adding practical examples, templates, and implementation guidance.

Nonactionable feedback: Expressed general support for the draft’s direction, structure, and balance; a small number of comments were negative or dissenting.

Public Comment: Revisions Already Incorporated

Current revised draft:

- With comments and markup: [“Responsible AI Use Policy \(Draft\) v2.0_Markup”](#).
- Without comments and markup: [“Responsible AI Use Policy \(Draft\) v2.0_Clean”](#).
- Request access via Google Drive.

Straightforward revisions: Straightforward revisions were incorporated into the 2.0 draft as of **June 10, 2026**.

These include edits and clarifications related to:

- Reimbursement and purchasing guidance.
- Links to official GW AI, privacy, and data-classification resources.
- Addition of a policy update and review mechanism.
- Clarification of policy scope and audience.

Public Comment: Topics Requiring Further Deliberation

Several topics raised during the comment process required further deliberation before incorporating into the draft policy.

Topics with proposed policy recommendations addressed in the 2.0 draft as of **June 22, 2026**:

- Topic 1: Default rules for student AI use.
- Topic 2: Faculty and GA/TA use of AI in grading.
- Topic 3: “Must” versus “should” policy language.
- Topic 4: AI use disclosure guidance.

Deferred topics—not addressed in the 2.0 draft:

- Topic 5: Conscientious objection / opt-out.
- Topic 6: Faculty and staff AI training.
- Topic 7: Preamble discussion of academic freedom.
- Topic 8: Preamble discussion of AI risks and opportunities.

Topic 1: Default Rules for Student AI Use

Issue: The current default rule, based substantially on the [April 2023 provost guidance](#), may be difficult to apply because it does not clearly distinguish between AI-assisted learning and the submission of AI-generated work.

Recommendation: Adopt a realistic default rule based on student responsibility, disclosure, and instructor control:

- Students remain responsible for all submitted work.
- Students must disclose AI use when it materially shapes submitted work.
- Students may not submit AI-generated material as their own work or where unaided student performance is being assessed.
- Instructors may adopt more restrictive or permissive rules at the course or assignment level.

Topic 2: Faculty and GA/TA Use of AI in Grading

Issue: Comments raised concerns about fairness, transparency, privacy, appeal rights, and possible perceived hypocrisy if faculty use AI in grading.

Recommendation: Permit AI-assisted grading with clear conditions:

- An instructor or GA/TA must review and remain responsible for the final grade.
- Student data must be protected through GW-approved tools or appropriate anonymization.
- Students should be notified when AI materially supports grading or feedback.
- Ordinary grade-review and appeal processes remain available.

Topic 3: “Must” Versus “Should” Policy Language

Issue: The draft must distinguish binding requirements from recommended practices without becoming heavy-handed or too vague.

Recommendation:

Use “**must**” for core requirements, such as:

- Compliance with applicable GW policies.
- Prohibitions on using public AI tools with protected data.
- Academic-integrity obligations.
- Human review for consequential AI-assisted decisions.

Use “**should**” for other expectations and best practices that are not backed by GW policies.

Topic 4: AI Use Disclosure Guidance

Issue: Disclosure is a complex judgment call. We don't disclose our use of search engines—that's assumed today. However, AI use should likely be disclosed in many consequential or public-facing scenarios.

Recommendation:

Embrace complexity; allow for human judgment.

- Distinguish between disclosure and authorization.
- Prohibit undisclosed AI-based impersonation (via agents, digital twins, “deepfakes,” etc.).
- Students should document and credit AI-based sources.
- Follow publisher guidelines on disclosing AI use.
- Allow for a judgment call between “routine” and “consequential” use.

Deferred Topics

- **Topic 5: Conscientious objection / opt-out concerns**—Broader governance issue; out-of-scope for a usage policy; no AI-specific GW-wide policy references.
- **Topic 6: Faculty and staff AI training**—Broader governance issue; out-of-scope for a usage policy; no AI-specific GW-wide policy references.
- **Topic 7: Preamble discussion of academic freedom**—Out-of-scope for a usage policy; not frequently addressed in introductory text of other GW policies.
- **Topic 8: Preamble discussion of AI risks and opportunities**—Potentially out-of-scope for a usage policy; technology benefits and risks not frequently addressed in introductory text of other GW policies.